

RIP SINGLE PLAYER?

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In a recent column I spoke about how something had changed about the way I approached gaming. Choosing to go for quick and short bursts of gaming over the long gaming sessions that I used to have back in the day. For the most part, that still holds true. I had also brought up something along the lines of games themselves evolving, and as we get older, we're simply no longer the target audience. I concluded at the end of the column though that I didn't think it was my love for gaming that had dwindled, but simply the way I wanted to experience games.

Why am I bringing this up again? Well, I recently played through the Mass Effect Trilogy again, and I had no problem spending hours at a stretch, immersed into the game. This made me wonder, we don't really see games like Mass Effect all too often anymore. A lot of the newer single player experiences (rare as they are), simply pale in comparison. Why is that? Well, the answer in my opinion is quite simple. Money. It's always money. Video games, especially the “AAA” kind, take years to make, and millions of dollars to develop. Finally, we get our hands on the game for \$60, or around INR 4000 over here. In order to make bank on their investment, publishers are starting to move on from selling just individual copies to games as a service, and microtransactions.

As the ecosystem stands right now, these are primarily always online, mostly multiplayer-focused experiences, designed to ensure players keep coming back for more. It's a system that

works, one that works *really* well. So well in fact that even free-to-play games can come out the other side with some serious bank. Single player games on the other hand are expensive to make, arguably don't bring in anywhere near the amount of money you could make from following GaaS or MT models, and even the expansions are expensive and take time to make. If you were the owner of a business, you would obviously go for the model that costs the least for the most profit, right?

So where does that leave single player games? It's been said many times that single player games are dying out. I don't think they are, but they will certainly have to evolve in order to better fit into the ecosystem. Ubisoft took steps in this direction with Assassin's Creed, where they would provide more content over a period of time, to keep people coming back. They also had an MTX shop in a single player game (a grievous sin for some people), which was purely cosmetic for the most part and completely optional. But an avenue for them to make more money nonetheless. Like it or not, that's probably the future of single player experiences. What do you think? Let us know by writing in to us at editor@skoar.in, or you know, hop on to our Discord server. *